MICKLEHAM PARISH Magazine

A community magazine for Mickleham and Westhumble



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September 2026

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Mickleham Parish Magazine

September 2026

Mickleham Parish Magazine

A community magazine for Mickleham and Westhumble published under the auspices of Mickleham PCC with an independent editorial panel.

The magazine is published at the beginning of each month except January and August.

COPY DEADLINE

OCTOBER 2026 MAGAZINE

Sunday 6th September

send to:
editor@micklehammag.co.uk

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Contributions in any form are welcome as are good quality photographs. There is no charge for advertising local charity and community events. However the editors reserve the right to shorten, omit or reformat articles submitted for publication depending on space. Copy published is not necessarily the views of the editors or panel.

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Mickleham Rectory

Hi everyone,

How was your summer? I hope it was relaxing and there were highlights such as holidays, days out or family celebrations to be thankful to God for.

It was extremely hot and dry. Plants, grass, trees, birds, animals, bees struggled with heat and lack of water. It was difficult to keep our plants alive, sad to see straw-coloured lawns and sleeping was more difficult. Some people struggled but, for most, it was good not to need a jumper or coat, enjoy lovely evenings and early mornings, iced drinks and ice cream. Fortunately, we did not suffer from the terrible wildfires that severely affected some places.

There is little doubt our climate is changing, and hot summers are more frequent and hotter! We have known about climate change for a while but have been slow to respond. Maybe this summer will remind us that more needs to be done to limit global warming. I'm sure many of us try to minimise our carbon emissions but it is good to review the impact of travel, both local and international, food and wastage, energy use and sources and consider what can be changed.

The Church of England has introduced the Festival of Creation in Christ, when we can celebrate and give thanks for Creation and recognise Christ's role in making and sustaining the world and dying for its redemption. It gives opportunity to think about environmental stewardship. I believe it is important that we care for creation because it is God's, humanity was called to look after it from the beginning, we need to preserve our beautiful planet and our lovely area for future generations to enable everyone to enjoy it and be sustained by it.

St Michael's is holding two services that will focus on nature and the environment. The first is our tent service in the rectory garden (6th September), where we will be celebrating creation and our local natural world and reflecting on how we can be better stewards of it. The second is Harvest (4th October) where we give thanks for our food, express gratitude to farmers and those who produce it and think about limiting waste and reducing the carbon emissions associated with food. Harvest Service will be preceded by a children's craft workshop at 10 am in church and followed by a light lunch. Do come along!

One other special service on 27th September will feature the Christian Motorbike Association, following on from the successful service at the end of May.

On Tuesday 21st July the last children left St Michael's Infant school. A sad day. The celebrations in church and in the school on 5th July had highlighted how much the school had been valued by the pupils, staff, parents, volunteers and community. My thanks to all who contributed to that service, especially Jenny Hudlass. On behalf of the church, I would like to say a huge thank you to all who worked so hard to make St Michael's such a special school, which gave so many children a great start to their education and spiritual growth and made it a valued part of our community.

God bless,

Sandra

The Rev'd Dr Sandra Faccini, Parish Priest

The school service on 5th July can be found at **https://youtu.be/YoB2zKreDjA**

Please see details of a special outdoor service celebrating nature on page 23 and the children's Harvest Workshop on page 27.

St Michael's Church Services



10 am Sunday Services available on Zoom

Joining information for both Zoom and telephone users is available in Pews News Online each week. If you would like to join us by Zoom then contact Alison Wood for the codes or to ask her to include you on the emailing list for Pews News: **admin@micklehamchurch.org.uk** / phone 01372 376443. We hope as many of you as possible will be able to join us for worship.

Please refer to Pews News Online for the latest information. If you missed any of the services or would like to revisit them all are available on the church YouTube channel: **https://youtube.com/channel/UCl4pbewCT91iZhcdoEjJBIw**

Men's and Women's Breakfasts

9-10 am at the Stepping Stones pub

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NEXT BREAKFAST
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Book with:
Andy Diamond
adiamond714@gmail.com



BIBLE STUDY

All welcome

At Westhumble Chapel

Monday evening group
7.45 pm till 9 pm
The group will resume on Monday 14th September after a summer break.

Please contact Amanda on **aewadsworth@hotmailcom** if you would like more information.

Thursday morning group
11 am for an 11.30 start until 12.30 pm
The group will resume on Thursday 10th September.

If you would like to join us, please call Alison Wood on 01372 376443 or 07905 985928.



First Saturday of the month

Coffee Morning

Westhumble Chapel

Saturday 5th September

Come along between 10 am and 12 noon

Coffee and cake £2 Free drinks for children

Everyone welcome

For further information call Jonathan Blake 07787 126966



Tea @ 3

Monday 21st September

Host: Revd Mandy MacVean
34 Oakdene Close, Brockham, RH3 7JZ

ALL WELCOME TRANSPORT AVAILABLE

If you can help with future events, please contact Julia at **siberrman@btinternet.com**

St Michael's Church Community Group

Food Bank Collection

We welcome items for adults, children and infants including:

• non-perishable food • laundry and cleaning supplies • personal hygiene products



LOCAL COLLECTION POINTS

MICKLEHAM
Garden Corner off Old London Road
Mary Banfield 01372 373912

WESTHUMBLE
St Anthony Pilgrims Way
Sue Tatham 01306 882547

The Stepping Stones
Westhumble Street



Also items may be brought to Coffee Mornings at Westhumble Chapel and St Michael's Church on Sunday mornings

To make monetary donations go to: https://dorkingarea.foodbank.org.uk/give-help/donate-money/

CHECK THE COMMUNITY WHATSAPP EACH WEEK FOR ITEMS CURRENTLY IN SHORT SUPPLY

St Michael's Community Group



Thank You from the Foodbank

The Dorking Foodbank now supports around 3,000 individuals each week and that number is sadly, still rising as financial pressures grow.

Although our parish community may be small, your generosity makes a real and meaningful difference. A special thank you to those that regularly contribute food and financial support to help with growing need. We are deeply grateful. You help bring hope and practical care to our neighbours in challenging times.

If you would like to help, but don't know how then please contact kelvin at **kelvin@wan2lan.com**

Autumn Lunches All welcome

The wait is nearly over! This autumn, enjoy a chance to meet up with friends over delicious homemade soup and a tempting selection of cheeses. We have just two lunch dates this year, so be sure to mark your diary.

Thursday 22nd October and Thursday 19th November at the Mickleham Village Hall. Doors open at 12:45 pm, and lunch will be served from 1 pm.

There is no charge for the food, but donations will be gratefully received, with all proceeds going to local charities (including the Foodbank).

To help us plan quantities, please book your place with Andy Diamond by calling 07789 775354 or email **adiamond714@gmail.com**. Spaces are limited, so book early!

Kelvin Pritchard



All are welcome to a special service, with a talk by ex-missionary Dave, from the Christian Motorbike Association.

St Michael and All Angels Church Mickleham

Sunday 27th September 10am



This summer's last Sunday Afternoon Teas with homemade cakes at St Michael's Church, Mickleham 3 – 5 pm 27th September

We were very sad to hear of the death of Barry Moughton on 1st July. Our deepest sympathy to Elizabeth and family. There will be a service to celebrate his life at St Michael's Church on Monday 2nd November at 11.30 am.

heritage open days

Mole Valley 11th – 20th September

THIS YEAR'S THEME

EVERYDAY HISTORIES; Exploring daily working life through the ages

Events at St Michael's Church, Mickleham

Saturday 19th September 10 am - 4 pm

A church has stood on this site for over a thousand years and for all that time people have marked the major events in their lives at the church: births, marriages, and deaths. Churches provide a fascinating insight into family and local history and our local history group has undertaken and produced an amazing and detailed survey of the churchyard. Our historic church records are now stored mainly in the public archive at the Surrey History Centre, Woking and are accessible to all. The church and churchyard themselves are a treasure trove of fascinating memorials and headstones: from generations of local families to the only Canadian prime minister buried outside Canada, from an eminent Stuart confectioner to Commonwealth war graves.

Whether you are a regular visitor to St Michael's or you have never been to the church at all, please join us on our Heritage Open Day to take a closer look at the church and churchyard, enjoy the history group's display and wander at your leisure.

Tea, coffee and biscuits will be available all day.

Mickleham & Westhumble Local History Group Exhibition

Not such Everyday Lives

This year's local history group HOD event will include a digital presentation of archive photographs showing everyday lives in Mickleham & Westhumble. The accompanying exhibition will highlight some of the interesting village characters with everyday occupations and once-everyday occupations that have disappeared.



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Westhumble Residents Association
Committee Meeting 15th July

The railway bridge continues to be a cause of concern, and the matter has now been taken up by our MP, Chris Coghlan, who is to arrange a meeting between Surrey County Council (SCC) and the incoming East Surrey Councillors (ESC) to plan a route forward. The most important factor was felt to be the restrictions on access for emergency vehicles and consideration will also need to be given to maintaining access through any works.

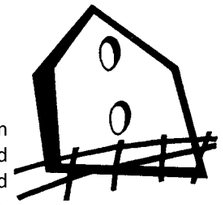
The remaining double yellow lines on Westhumble Street are on SCC's work programme for completion before April 2027. The condition of Westhumble Street has deteriorated to the extent that a complete resurfacing will be required but it is unlikely that SCC will manage to undertake this before it disappears next March. The incoming ESC have been notified.

Vegetation needs to be cut back along Chapel Lane, and a working party will be organised to undertake this. Most of the vegetation on the footpath between Chapel Lane, Adlers Lane and Denbies has been pruned but householders adjoining the path are asked to check if further pruning is required.

Mole Valley District Council (MVDC) informed us that the determination of boundaries for non-parished communities like Westhumble was down to the community itself. The Committee discussed and agreed the boundaries of the village should be:

- To the properties at the bottom of Bagden Hill
- The properties at the bottom of Ranmore Common Road
- Burford Lodge and neighbouring properties alongside the east of the A24
- Moleford Cottages and other properties alongside the west of the A24
- Denbies Lodge
- The properties at the top of Crabtree Lane

The Chair has discussed with Will Dennis (Mickleham Parish Council Chairman), David Ireland and Erin Olivier the idea of having a Westhumble and Mickleham joint social event. The first event would take place in June 2027 and would be held in Mickleham.



It would be a village fair style event. Westhumble would reciprocate in 2028. It was hoped that either event would be well supported by both villages. Some funding was required to kick off the planning and organising. The Committee agreed that WRA should commit £500. It was expected that the event would recoup its costs and the Committee were content that WRA's funding could go to the chosen event charity.

The removal of bins from the station continues to be a cause of concern. Several residents have complained directly to Govia Thameslink who manage the station on behalf of Southern. Chris Coghlan has also become involved, posting an interview on Facebook.

The Westhumble bonfire this year will be on Saturday 7th November.

The next committee meeting will be held on Wednesday 23rd September.

Chris Budleigh (Chair)

Working Together to Address Anti-Social Vehicle Behaviour on the Zig Zag Road

Residents of Mickleham and the wider Box Hill area will be aware of the increasing anti-social vehicle activity affecting the Zig Zag Road and surrounds, particularly on some evenings and overnight. The National Trust has seen a significant rise in issues including excessive noise, speeding, dangerous driving, road obstruction and littering. These activities disrupt the local community, affect visitors' enjoyment of the area and impact the special landscape.

In response, the National Trust has been working with Surrey Police and Mole Valley District Council (MVDC) on a coordinated approach to address the problem. A key milestone has been the introduction of a Public Spaces Protection Order (PSPO), which includes the Zig Zag Road and gives police and authorised council officers additional powers to take action against anti-social vehicle behaviour. Before enforcement can begin, new signage must be installed across the area, and residents can expect to see signs appearing in the coming months. We hope this is a temporary measure.

Alongside the PSPO, the National Trust is trialling targeted road closures at known peak times for anti-social activity. Working with security contractors and supported by MVDC and Surrey Police, access to the Zig Zag Road will be temporarily restricted on selected evenings to discourage gatherings and disrupt established patterns of behaviour.

Importantly, these measures are aimed at tackling anti-social vehicle behaviour, not responsible users. Box Hill has a long association with the motorcycling community, and the vast majority of visitors use the area respectfully and responsibly.

The National Trust remains committed to working with local partners and residents to create a safer and more welcoming environment for everyone. Through a combination of engagement, clear expectations and targeted enforcement, the aim is to reduce disturbance, improve safety and protect the special nature of Box Hill and the Zig Zag Road for the future.

James Nicholson, National Trust



©National Trust Images/John Miller

A Bittersweet Celebration of St Michael's School



For some time, the future of St Michael's School has been uncertain. Throughout the country falling roles have been rendering small schools unviable. In 1970 St Michael's was an all-through primary with 115 pupils on the roll. At the beginning of this last year there were only 18.

Earlier this year SCC began the process of closing the school. A group including present and potential future parents made a valiant effort to save St Michael's. The church and school began planning a celebration of the school for Sunday 5th July assuming that by this time its fate would be known. However, because of changes in local government the final decision was delayed until 7th July. Nevertheless, the day of celebration in both in church and at the school proved a momentous occasion.

Celebrations started in St Michael's Church which was packed with former and current pupils, parents, governors, teachers and staff in addition to the usual congregation. Fomer headteacher Jenny Hudlass, started with the historic background of St Michael's School. Because of space constraints this will be included in the October issue.

For the rest of the service we heard memories from former and present headteachers and governors, parents and pupils. First off **Jenny Hudlass** shared with us the highlights of her 18-year tenure.

When Jenny took up the headship at St Michael's in 1985 there were 30 children in the school. Budget restraints meant that she had to be a 3-day class teacher as well as headteacher. She recalls:

• Winning a minibus in SCC's 1986 Schools Conservation Project to encourage schools to conserve energy and show a saving on their fuel expenditure. The red Sherpa van was a familiar sight around the area for over 13 years

• Creating the Friends of St Michael's School to replace the PTA which didn't provide sufficient support for a small rural school

• Integrating appreciation of the school's outstandingly beautiful environment into the school curriculum. Creating our own 'Study Garden'. Forming strong links with Juniper Hall Field Study Centre and the National Trust. Our pupils trialled Juniper Hall's scheme to bring younger primary and infant-aged children out into the field. With the National Trust we were involved in the early stages of its Guardianship Scheme

• Following the Education Reform Act 1988, budget control was transferred from the LEA directly to school headteachers and governors. Small schools began to struggle with this revised arrangement, especially as the heads had class-teaching commitments

• Forming a small-school consortium among local village schools. This enabled us to meet colleagues in a similar situation, share ideas and share training for staff and governors who were also new to running a budget. It gave us better buying power for resources and training

• The 1992 SCC introduction of the Age of Transfer, which reorganised school structures, creating infant and junior schools throughout Surrey. Within this scheme St Michael's was threatened with closure, not that we were underachieving or undersubscribed, it was merely a move to absorb smaller village first schools with the larger, more cost-effective town schools

• Presenting a 34-page document to the Education Committee prior to the meeting at County Hall, which would not only determine our future but that of many schools in Surrey. Our group of supporters outside County Hall in Kingston with SAVE OUR SCHOOL banners. Canon Tony Chanter the then Diocesan Director of Education, eloquently put our case for the future of our school, and the rest is history. St Michael's was saved.

• Helping to found St Michael's Community Nursery to provide Mickleham with high-quality early years education to match its very successful village school. Sited in the village hall, it provided local children with a seamless progression from nursery to 'big school'.

'I will always feel extremely privileged to have been part of the continuing development of St Michael's School over this period.'

Anne Hossack, headteacher from 2003 to 2014, continued with the highlights of her time at the school.

'I joined St Michael's in 2003 initially as an interim head. The fact that I stayed until 2014 when I retired is testimony to what a wonderful place to learn it has been.' Some highlights:

• Changing to an Infant School with 30 children in each of the three years: Reception, Year 1 and Year 2.

• The gradual development of the facilities on the site:

- The old toilet blocks behind the school adapted for storage

- A covered outdoor play space created for the Early Years

- A new entrance and office with a private space for children to sit when hurt or unwell.

- Improved staff accommodation including a roomy headteacher's office

• The months that Marisa Piggot, Sam Rathband and I worked in a container that was freezing cold!

• Helping with the plans for the final major development which included the removal of a mobile classroom (freezing in winter and unbearably hot in summer), the creation of a new classroom from the old hall space and a super new hall, servery and dedicated library space.

• Enrichment activities: Year 2's violin lessons by Yehudi Menuhin school students; the sound of a large group of beginner violinists practising together was unforgettable, as was the look of pride on their and their parents' faces when they performed in the Menuhin Concert Hall with the school's talented musicians

• Working with David and Jane Ireland to develop a series of children's workshops marking church festivals, hosted by the school on Saturday mornings then celebrated in church on Sundays

• Celebrating the school's centenary in 2007 which included rededication of the school by the Bishop of Dorking, a service in church, planting a tree at school, tea in the rectory garden where the celebratory cake comprised 100 cupcakes made and decorated by the children. Later a fun day of activities reminiscent of a traditional fair, with country dancing by the children. Finally, an open day at school, with children wearing Edwardian dress and a traditional school lunch provided in the village hall

'I hold so many precious memories, fundamentally dominated by an overwhelming feeling of a school wrapped in the love of the whole community: children, staff, parents, governors, local residents and church.'

Pat Hand, Chair of Governors, continued.

'During the 14 years I have served as school governor there have been:

• Four school heads and re-structuring

• Significant cuts to educational budgets and resourcing, especially for village schools

• Ofsted changes in school inspections and how judgements are made

• Increasing levels of accountability for safeguarding and welfare, especially concerning those with special or additional needs

• Big changes in educational policies about what should be taught and how, creating a need for supporting staff to adapt and manage changes.

• Increasing testing and the pressures on children, staff and, in turn, families now reduced for the youngest

• Growth of Academy Trusts leading to gradual loss of collaboration and partnership among schools.

• Diminishing of the County Council role and systems of support for schools

• Joy and benefits of trusting partnership with Newdigate, a village church school like us

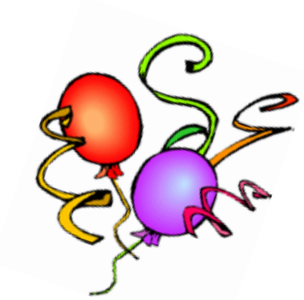
• Challenges and learning during the pandemic. So much creative thinking went into managing access to resources and keeping the sense of being part of a school community with some key workers in and some not eligible. We learned to use Zoom and Teams with online meetings

• Back to school was both wonderful and challenging, establishing friendship groups, school routines and behaviour, winners and losers in games. The sense that life has not been quite the same since.'

'I honour the many governors I have had the privilege to serve with at St Michael's. Between us we manged to support and enable St Michael's to provide an exceptional learning environment with fabulous staff and leadership; manage very tight budgets, have a wonderful well-maintained environment (thanks to Ben Tatham and Tony Butler) and enjoy the extensive and valuable support of our local community and church. I have learned a great deal through being a governor and I am very thankful for having the privilege of being part of and supported by a very creative, knowledgeable, hard-working group of volunteers.'

The service continued with interesting and often amusing accounts from former parents and pupils, including a short video message from the Hodges family, now living in Australia. As there is insufficient space here to do them justice, they will be included in next month's magazine along with the school's early history.

Sue Tatham



Celebrations at the School

As the service lasted longer than planned, there was a flurry of activity at the school when the congregation arrived to join the others who had gone there directly. There was much excitement as school friends, parents and staff came together, sometimes after many years.

Various displays, chairs and tables had been set up in the school hall. The 300 people who had booked were presented with delicious packed lunches – boxes for the adults, special bags for the children. They were joined by many others who hadnt booked lunch.

The many children made a beeline for the bouncy castle in the playground. Other games had been set out and, of course, there was an ice cream van which did a roaring trade. Guided tours of the school were offered during the afternoon.

It was a glorious occasion spent renewing old friendships and reminiscing. Only later were we to discover that everyone had been so busy working or chatting, that no one thought to take any photographs of the party at its height. Therefore, we are unable to include any pictures here.

Sue Tatham

THE FINAL DECISION

On 7th July the Education Authority announced that the school was to shut, and so on 22nd July St Michaels CofE School, once called a 'hidden gem' in an Ofsted report, closed its doors for the last time.

The future use of the site and buildings remains unclear, with some legal issues needing to be resolved in the coming months.

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KING WILLIAM IV

Dear Friends/Neighbours

The summer was outstanding with amazing reviews for our food and service, and another 5-star food hygiene rating (which I'm guessing is our eighth consecutive one). Kat and the team are doing brilliantly.

We hope for a lovely sunny September, although some rain would also be extremely welcome! Kat is already planning the new autumn menu and asked us to mention the C-word, as apparently a number of tables are already booked for Christmas Day and family parties.

Hope to see you soon, Anne & Eamonn

Byttom Hill Mickleham 01372 372590 www.thekingwilliamiv.com

Southern Trains Rubbish

We are lucky to have the beautiful Surrey Hills, both for people who live here and those who visit from outside of the area. I believe it is our collective responsibility to make sure this area is maintained and cherished and one of the key signs of this is to ensure a litter-free environment. So, when we hear that one of the main beneficiaries of people visiting this area, Govia Thameslink Railway or Southern, have decided in their wisdom to remove litter bins from the station, I was genuinely perplexed.

When consequently, I saw litter left on the platform, I complained to Southern but had no response. At the same time, I wrote to Chris Coghlan our MP, who took this up directly with Southern and did receive a reply. It turns out the new government legislation requesting rubbish to be segregated into specific waste bins at source had led to Southern management deciding that the best policy for dealing with this was to remove the bins entirely!

This beggars belief and spurious reasons were given for the rationale, including not having sufficient space at the station to store bins for various types of litter. Fundamentally, I believe this is a big organisation deciding in the interests of their profit margin to simply make this problem go away. Forget the consequences, forget the impact on the area, forget the impression it gives to everyone about what is acceptable.

Of course, the problem doesn't go away, even for Southern. People still visit the area, particularly at the weekend. So, while Southern classify Box Hill and Westhumble as a small station and therefore not in need of any bins, there really is a big demand at the weekend for somewhere to dispose of rubbish. Visitors will have litter from drinks and food but now they will have nowhere to put it when they arrive.

Southern cleaning staff now need to visit regularly and pick up the litter at an increased cost. What are they going to do with it? Put it in a big black bag and send it to landfill? No sorting, no recycling and no complying with the spirit of the government legislation.

To summarise, the results are clear:

- Platforms welcoming visitors arriving with litter and the wider area of Westhumble experiencing more littering.
- Reduced recycling, the same litter gets dealt with exactly as before despite the government's best efforts – it's just picked up from the platform rather than taken from the bins.
- Greater clean-up costs for Southern than before.

When I researched how other rail companies are dealing with this issue I saw that Great Western Railways, which is also nationalised, is taking a proper, responsible approach. Segregated bins are being introduced, and no bins are being removed from small stations. SWR has really showcased how it is trying and succeeding in improving its recycling rates. How refreshing to see management dealing with the challenge in a constructive way.

Of course, Southern's biggest weapon, is our apathy. They are betting that people will not bother to complain and that after a while, we will get used to the status quo, accepting lower standards of tidiness. I am grateful to Chris for his efforts to hold Southern to account, but it also needs your help.

If you are concerned about your environment and you believe in more recycling, you should challenge the management of Southern by lodging a complaint on their web site.

Here is the link:

https://www.southernrailway.com/help-and-support/contact-us

David Farmery



Editor's Note
The keen eyed among you will realise that this image has been photoshopped. The editing was to remove a person, the giveaway is that the name corrected to Biffet rather than Biffa. However, it is a true representation of the rubbish that accumulated in only a few days. The bin was put in place shortly after David's conversation and has subsequently been removed without any information as to why. We can only guess that it was a surprise how quickly it overfilled.

In aid of the Brigitte Trust
Charity Bridge Lunch • Prizes • Raffle
Westcott Village Hall 10am to 3.45pm
Friday 16th October
£100 per table of 4
Coffee on arrival, home-cooked lunch, glass of wine, dessert
Please bring tablecloth for lunch, playing cards and bidding boxes
Contact Ann Austin at: **annjohn.austin@gmail.com**

ME and Long Covid Workshop
Wednesday 23rd September
1 - 2.30 pm on Zoom
Led by the ME Association, a national charity supporting people affected by ME/CFS and, more recently, Long Covid, this session will provide an overview of the current landscape for these conditions.
Please book by emailing Mandy **mandy.east@brigittetrust.com**
Zoom link will be sent out the week before the workshop.

Mickleham Choral Society Summer Concert

After our trip to Sinalunga we brought back not just the Tuscan weather but a repertoire of Italian music for our summer concert on 20th June.



As is customary, we began proceedings with a picnic outside the village hall then took up positions inside for the concert. For those of us in the choir on the precipitous top shelf of the staging, the rising heat provided a free, though fully clothed, sauna. The audience sat in the comparative luxury of a through draught from the open doors, which also gave passing pedestrians reason to halt, listen and film the spectacle before them.



We opened the concert with Vivaldi's glorious *Gloria*, which sounded rather good to my biased ear. Special mention of the fabulous soloists is due: Jane Hughes and Tracy Kennington (soprano), Teresa Wood, Ambie Desoutter and Jac Kenney (alto) and Julia Philpott (oboe).

There was a short break for air and refreshments before the Italian theme continued. The Caccini and Rossini versions of *Ave Maria* and *Santa Lucia* were sung by the women, but it was Rick Singh who nearly sent the audience out barefoot by blowing our socks off with his solo and unaccompanied rendition of *O Sole Mio*. The applause was loud and long.

The three songs we sang at the Leith Hill Music Festival were followed by a trio of Gill Herbert (violin), Richard Wright (guitar) and Annie Dennis (double bass) playing *Libiamo* and *Funiculi Funicula*, preparing the audience to join in with the latter as the choir sang the tongue twister Italian lyrics.

Of course, it would not be an Italian concert without the rousing *Chorus of the Hebrew Slaves* by Verdi, known to us as *Va Pensiero*, to send everyone out thinking of Cornettos and booking flights to Il Bel Paese.

Dina Stovell

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paulinedavis33@icloud.com

GS at the Village Horticultural Show

What wonderful weather we had for this year's horticultural show. The Garden Shed was there once again, and it was lovely to see so many familiar faces stopping by. Richard and Silvia joined us with their ever-popular sharpening service, and they were kept busy with all the garden tools and kitchen knives that came their way. As well as leaving everything sharp and shiny, he shared plenty of handy tips on how to look after your tools at home.



Thanks to everyone who popped along and supported us, we were able to make a donation to Home-Start UK, a charity supporting families with young children in the community.

Cathy Lee

Editor's note. We took along a serrated bread knife, doubting that Richard would be able to help. He did an excellent job, now it glides through every loaf that we have tried.

Mickleham and Westhumble Horticultural Society
Summer Show Saturday 11th July

Here are the results from the Horticultural Society Village Show. On another scorching summer day, there was the usual good attendance and some impressive entries. The committee would like to thank Fiona Taylor in particular for being our VIP and for handing out the prizes, and all those attending who braved the heat!

David Kennington







Cup and medal winners

Paynter Cup, vegetable garden full of promise	Pauline Davis
Aitken Cup, border full of colour	Pauline Davis
Ellman Cup, most outstanding exhibit – flowers	Valerie Leake
Robson Cup, most outstanding entry – vegetables	Pauline Davis
Schreiber Cup, most outstanding entry – fruit	Sophie Adshead
Gordon Clark Cup, most outstanding entry – floral arrangements	Alison Walton
Dennis Trophy, most outstanding entry – cookery	Roland Halliwell
Vi Bullen Trophy, most outstanding entry – arts and crafts	Gemma Golding
Alan Huggett Memorial Cup, best sweet peas	No entry
Taylor Cup, most points – cookery	Sophie Adshead
Colwell Cup, most points – arts and crafts	Clive/Angela Gilchrist
Bronze Banksian Medal, most points – horticulture	Pauline Davis
Salomons Cup, most points in show	Sophie Adshead
Heygate Cup, most points in show 5 - 8 years	Sebastian McIlwraith-Jay
Wilkinson Cup, most points in show over 9 years	Audrey Valentine

Apologies to the winners of individual categories who are too many to print here. They are listed on the M&WHS website.





Photos anti-clockwise from the top
The last St Michael's Infant School entry, Pauline Davis and Fiona Taylor, Sophie Adshead by Isabel Budleigh, Valerie Leake's cup-winning roses, the overall hall by Judith Long.

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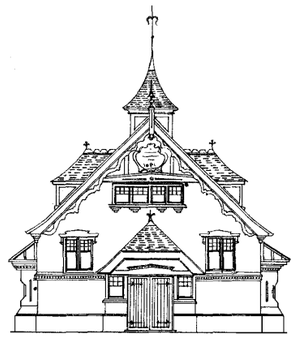
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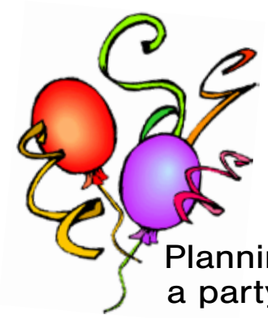
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Friends of Box Hill – Chair Lyn Richards 01737 842889 lyn@mra.uk.net

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DORKING GROUP OF ARTISTS
Exhibition Secretary – Patricia Booth patriciabooth100@gmail.com

DORKING LAWN TENNIS & SQUASH CLUB
Maddy Halliwell madeline_halliwell@hotmail.co.uk

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Pauline Davis paulinedavis33@ @icloud.com

JUNIPER HALL FIELD CENTRE 01306 734501 enquiries.jh@field-studies-council.org
Head of Centre – Sarah Wyper s.wyper@field-studies-council.org
Friends of Juniper Hall friendsofjuniperhall.org friendsofjuniperhall@gmail.com

MICKLEHAM & WESTHUMBLE BADMINTON CLUB
Membership Secretary – Sarah Pritchard tinkerbell0044@hotmail.com

MICKLEHAM CHILDREN'S PLAYGROUND ASSOCIATION
Secretary – Sarah Parfitt 07767 891772 sarah@sarahparfitt.com

MICKLEHAM CHORAL SOCIETY www.micklehamchoral.org.uk
THURSDAYS 8 - 10 pm – MICKLEHAM VILLAGE HALL
Conductor – Juliet Hornby 01372 373106
Secretary – Mike Benson secretary@micklehamchoral.org.uk

MICKLEHAM CRICKET CLUB
Membership contact – Will Dennis 07903 842674 will@micklehamhallfarm.co.uk

MICKLEHAM OLD BOX HILLIANS FOOTBALL CLUB
Secretary – John Atewell 01372 374745

MICKLEHAM PARISH COUNCIL
SEE WEBSITE FOR MEETING DATES www.micklehamparishcouncil.gov.uk
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MICKLEHAM & WESTHUMBLE HORTICULTURAL SOCIETY
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ST MICHAEL'S CHURCH

within the United Benefice of Leatherhead and Mickleham

INCUMBENT – The Rev'd Will Perry 01372 372313

PARISH PRIEST

The Rev'd Dr Sandra Faccini * 01372 417664
07763 488961
parishpriest@micklehamchurch.org.uk
* Main working days: Monday, Tuesday and Sunday

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cwa@micklehamchurch.org.uk

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Annette Collinge 07809 684625
pv@micklehamchurch.org.uk

www.micklehamchurch.org.uk

For information about services for other denominations see website pages.
Search on 'Churches Together Mole Valley'

CALENDAR

SEPTEMBER

1	Tuesday	7 pm	Compline in church
		7.30 pm	GS talk at Stepping Stones pub p10
5	Saturday	10 am – noon	Coffee at Westhumble Chapel p2
6	**SUNDAY – Fourteenth Sunday after Trinity**		
		10 am	Special Outdoor Service in rectory garden p23

Deadline for October MPM

9	Wednesday	7.30 pm	MPC meeting in Ranmore Room p28
10	Thursday	11 am to 12.30 pm	Thursday morning Bible Group resumes p3
13	**SUNDAY – Fifteenth Sunday after Trinity**		
		8 am	BCP Holy Communion at Westhumble Chapel
		10 am	Holy Communion
14	Monday	7.45 to 9 pm	Monday evening Bible Group resumes p2
15	Tuesday	7 pm	Compline in church
19	Saturday	9 to 10 am	Women's breakfast at Stepping Stones pub p2
		10 am to 4 pm	Heritage Open Day at church p3
20	**SUNDAY – Sixteenth Sunday after Trinity**		
		10 am	Holy Communion
21	Monday	3 pm	Tea@3 p2
23	Wednesday	7.30 pm	WRA meeting at Westhumble Chapel
26	Saturday	9 to 10 am	Men's breakfast at Stepping Stones pub p2
27	**SUNDAY – Seventeenth Sunday after Trinity**		
		8 am	BCP Holy Communion at Westhumble Chapel
		10 am	Service with Christian Motorbike Association p3
		3 to 5 pm	Last Sunday Tea at church p3



Dates for your diary

Sunday 4th October	Children's Harvest workshop at church 10 am p26 Harvest thanksgiving service for all ages at 11 am
Saturday 10th October	First bonfire build day p21 for remainder
Thursday 22nd October	Autumn lunch at MVH p3
Monday 2nd November	Celebration of the life of Barry Moughton at church
Saturday 7th November	Westhumble bonfire

MEMBERS OF THE PAROCHIAL CHURCH COUNCIL

Andy Diamond	Elaine Machin
Celia Lyons	Tim Mathieson
Caroline Jones	Beverley Mehta
Vickie Leney	Richard Siberry
Susan McGrath	Amanda Wadsworth
Paddy MacVean	Annette Collinge

ST MICHAEL'S CHURCH COMMUNITY GROUP COMMITTEE

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Denise Darling	07780 673372 denisedarling4@btinternet.com
Andy Diamond	07789 775354 adiamond714@gmail.com
Kelvin Pritchard	07770 280410 Kelvin@wan2lan.com

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Mary Banfield 01372 373912 **mgbbmw@aol.com**
Frances Presley 01306 882473 **jasempres@gmail.com**

More helpers needed – please contact Frances if you can spare some time.

REGISTER

BAPTISM	
Sunday 21st June	Valerie Headland
Sunday 2nd August	Joshua John and Thomas James, sons of Sam and Lana Eagers
FUNERAL	
Friday 3rd July	Paul Douglas Hayford
Tuesday 14th July	James Joseph (Jim) Robinson
INTERMENT OF ASHES	
Sunday 26th July	James Robert (Jim) Fuller
Sunday 15th August	Graham Headland
WEDDING	
Saturday 1st August	Grant Turner and Nicole Higgett

Community Directory

Continued from page 13

MICKLEHAM AND WESTHUMBLE LOCAL HISTORY GROUP
Chairman – Roger Davis 07759 042406
rogermdavis@icloud.com or www.micklehamwesthumblehistory.co.uk

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RGS SURREY HILLS
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reception@rgs-surreyhills.org

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Supervisor – Hilary Budd 01372 361021
stmichaelsnursery@btinternet.com

SURREY COUNTY COUNCIL 03456 009 009
Councillor – Hazel Watson 01306 880120
hva.watson@btinternet.com

SURREY WILDLIFE TRUST 01483 795440
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Dorking – Sue Tatham 01306 882547
Leatherhead – Beverley Mehta 01372 374304

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WHATSAPP GROUP
Neil MacKay nlpm@lineone.net

ADDITIONAL CONTACT INFORMATION

CITIZENS ADVICE
Dorking – Lyons Court 01306 732302
Leatherhead – Swan Mews High Street 01306 732301

CRIMESTOPPERS 0800 555 111

POLICE Non-emergencies 101
(often quicker to make online report) https://report.police.uk/
Neighbourhood Specialist Team – Dorking Rural East
General enquiries molevalley@surrey.pnn.police.uk

NHS Urgent and emergency care 111

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Mia McPhillips	* 07792 187160
Holly Flynn	*07917 434566

*Parent/partner's mobile number

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James Joseph Robinson, 'Jim'
1940 – 2026

A service in loving memory of Jim Robinson was held in St Michael's Church on 14th July. He died on 13th June aged 86.

Jim was a Dorking boy born and bred and attended Sondes Place School. Jim had a varied career. One of his first jobs was repairing shoes for Casselden's Shoes in South Street, consequently throughout his life he always had well-polished shoes. He then worked as a mechanic at Dorking Bus Garage. In the 1970s, he ran taxis and then became a chauffeur for a firm of City insurance brokers, retiring in 2000.

Jim met Rosemary Butcher, daughter of the then proprietor of Mickleham's Rose's Stores, on the top deck of a 470 bus. They were married in 1965 and set up house in Dorking. Son Paul was born in 1966 followed by David in 1968.

They moved to Dell Close, MIckleham in 1977. Even before moving to Mickleham Jim had joined John Clark's Mickleham Scout Troop as Cub Scout Leader. Scouting became a big part of his life. In his tribute to Jim in the service, Ernie Hall told us that he had first met Jim over 50 years ago through activities with the Mickleham Scout Group. He recalled that as Cub Leader, Jim organised some great outings. On one occasion they went to Bristol Zoo via an Intercity 125 train; another time they travelled to Portsmouth to visit HMS Victory.

Ernie recalled that all their camping trips seemed to involve water in one form or another. One was next to the river at Swanworth Farm. For the camp activity Jim had acquired an open Canadian canoe. When it was full of cubs he challenged them to lean the canoe over to see how far they could paddle it before it filled with water and everyone fell in. Thereafter wet canoeing became a favourite camp activity.

A few years later a group of scouting mates with a shared interest in exploring the UK formed 'Group 11' with Jim as the lynchpin. They met frequently in pubs to plan their trips. Jim's White Triumph 2000 was his pride and joy. Sometimes he let other members of the group drive it, but only under certain conditions, one of which was not exceeding 50 mph even on motorways.

Every trip that Jim arranged was full of banter, idle chat and a feeling of camaraderie. As for storytelling, camps and trips were on another scale with Jim. He revelled in the opportunity to weave a story and bring a load of fun to the occasions, with all taking part.

Ernie ended his tribute with 'Jim, you had so much talent and fun and we all grew and achieved so much under your guidance.'

Back in Mickleham Jim continued to socialise with friends in the 'Runners'. He served on the parish council, and enjoyed meeting up with his sons. Rosemary adds that he was quite a World War Two history buff, which has resulted in shelves full of books. This also influenced their holiday destinations.

In 2009 Jim was diagnosed with cancer, treatable but not curable. Jim ignored this and just got on with life. Unfortunately other illnesses caught up with him and his last few years were difficult. He remained upbeat throughout.

We send our love and deepest sympathy to Rosemary, Paul and David.

Sue Tatham

News from Friends of Box Hill

Lyn Richards, Chair of Friends of Box Hill has kindly allowed us to extract the three following items from the latest Friends of Box Hill newsletter as they were of particular interest to local residents.

We are very pleased to be undertaking a new project in conjunction with Juniper Hall Field Studies Centre. FOBH will fund twenty curriculum-linked days for primary school children to learn about and experience Box Hill. Field Studies Council tutors will deliver this. The aim is for pupils to develop knowledge, connection, and a commitment to Box Hill within their schools, families and communities helping to foster long term care, enjoyment and protection of the landscape. Juniper Hall, FOBH and National Trust will oversee this project over the next year. Local schools are currently being contacted, in addition to those in the wider area giving opportunities for disadvantaged children. They will be made aware of the funding available and the school visits to Box Hill will start in the autumn.

NT staff and the FOBH Committee decided that a lasting memorial for Mark Dawson would be fitting. Mark was Lead Ranger on Box Hill and passed away in March this year. The field below Dukes is likely to be named as Mark's Meadow. It is currently an un-named area of Box Hill. It has lovely chalk grassland flowers, and you may remember that Mark led a glowworm walk here for the Friends.



Another area that Mark liked was Mickleham Downs, but it has always had problems in that it is one of the few areas on Box Hill that cannot have conservation grazing because it is not fenced and does not have water available for cattle. NT are now preparing to graze the chalk grassland at Mickleham Gallops with Belted Galloways for the first time. Their preparation includes implementing stock-proof fencing (with pedestrian access gates) and a couple of troughs, one either side of the Gallops. They are planning to have the preparation works completed by Christmas. Introducing livestock to this area will help with species diversity and sward management in an area with difficult access.

Mickleham & Westhumble Local History Group

Visit to Park House Farmhouse



Park House Farmhouse is Grade II* listed and lies tucked away down a lane in Mynthurst where you would never come across it by chance. We had to split into two groups of ten to visit the house as the rooms are too small to accommodate larger numbers. The owner Ute Robertson, who has lived there for fifty years, gave us a brief outline of the history of the property and introduced us to her daughters, Pippa and Wendy, as we admired the garden. At the front is the oldest part of the house, built as a hall house in 1360 using oak growing nearby. Dendrochronology has confirmed there are beams inside dating back to this period. Some of these have carpenters' marks to help with assembly.

As with many old buildings, the house has undergone numerous changes, with both 15th and 17th century additions and further restoration in the 1930s. Walking up to the house, Ute pointed out the beehive chimney pot and told us the Horsham stone on the path used to be on the roof. At the back of the house is the well, which is 11m deep.

Inside the house, we heard that glass would have been too expensive for the farmer who first lived there and cow hide was used instead to cover the windows. Originally, there were no stairs, only a ladder to access the upper floor. Fortunately, that is no longer the case! Upstairs there were more beams to admire and walking through the bedrooms we noticed that each one has a bell, used years ago to summon the servants. Ute told us that in the 20th century a London businessman is said to have bought the house in order to bring his mistress there at weekends. The plan backfired when his wife discovered the house and moved in. In the last bedroom a surprise was in store. Pippa had decided that her mother needed to inject something more memorable into her tour and gave us a spirited rendition of John Donne's poem 'To his mistress going to bed'.

Back downstairs, our visit ended with delicious refreshments (the stollen was a particular hit) and a chance to chat some more with the family. We are very grateful to Ute for allowing us to visit her lovely house which is no longer open to the public.

Judith Long

Garden Shed Visit to Seale Rose Nursery

Following the excellent talk given to Garden Shed members last year, we were delighted to accept an invitation from David May to visit Seale Nursery and see their work at first hand. Not only did we receive a warm welcome from David and Catherine, but we were also greeted by the wonderful colour and fragrance of the roses throughout the nursery.

Seale has been a family run rose nursery on its current site in Farnham since the 1940s and is now run by David May and his wife Catherine. Over the years they have built an impressive reputation, winning numerous awards, including medals at the prestigious Chelsea Flower Show.

Although a lot has changed since the nursery was established, David explained that the biggest development has been in the way he propagates roses. Through years of experimentation, he has developed a grafting method that produces saleable roses within 12 months, compared with the three years typically required when growing roses from cuttings. David gave a live demonstration and then let us try,



which quickly showed it's not as easy as it looks.

Between June and August each year, around 1,000 roses are grafted on site. The rootstock is imported, as suitable rootstock is no longer available in the UK. While many rose growers now outsource production overseas, David remains committed to growing his roses here. His method also requires less land because the roses are grafted onto pot-grown rootstock. As a result, parts of the nursery are now being rewilded to encourage insects and other wildlife, although deer are definitely not welcome visitors.

David is entirely self-taught, having learned through trial and error rather than formal training. With a success rate of around 95%, however, he is clearly doing something right. Both David and Catherine admit they are not getting any younger, and while their family currently shows little interest in carrying on the business, they remain hopeful that one of the grandchildren may catch the rose-growing bug. It would be a great shame for such passion, knowledge and experience to be lost.

Cathy Lee



The Friends of Juniper Hall

Retirement of Chairman, Mavis Peart OBE

At the Friends of Juniper Hall's AGM on 9th July Mavis Peart retired after 19 years as its chairman. Going back to the establishment of the Friends in 1988/9, it is not long before Mavis's name appears in the minutes. As a member of the FSC Executive Committee at that time, Mavis had elected to support Juniper Hall as her nearest centre. She was co-opted onto the Friends of Juniper Hall Committee in May 1992, as an ex-officio member relating to her Vice-Presidential role in the FSC. She became chairman in 2007.



Mavis with her new wheelbarrow and a Juniper tree to remind her of Juniper Hall.

Throughout her time in the chair, Mavis has been instrumental in organising and running the programme of events, with talks on subjects as wide-ranging as reptiles to nightingales, gardening to ironmongery, Wartime Surrey to Florida wildlife, and Fanny Burney at Juniper Hall to Napoleon's last days on St Helena. Mavis persuaded several members of the Friends to contribute their knowledge and talent to the programme of events over the years, from talks on exotic butterflies to humorous musical performances with Instant Sunshine.

These enjoyable and informative social events, together with membership subscriptions and generous donations, and, in the past, income from the Butterfly Festival along with specific fundraising efforts, have funded many valuable projects at Juniper Hall that wouldn't otherwise have been possible.

In Mavis's time, the Friends have provided funds for equipment such as computers and information screens, chairs for the common room, a satellite dish for residential staff, curtains and lights for the Templeton room, beds and bedding, the educational pond, dining tables and benches, live mammal traps and the stretch tent. In addition, they have contributed thousands of pounds to refurbishment projects to enhance Juniper Hall as a Field Centre. Records show that since 1990 Juniper Hall has received more than £200,000 from the Friends.

The Friends' President, David Streeter in his tribute to Mavis remarked that the other 21 FSC centres are very jealous of Juniper Hall because of its Friends. 'How do they do it?' they ask. To which David replies 'Look no further than Mavis.' She leaves a huge legacy at Juniper Hall.

Mavis has had an incredible career centred around teaching geography and championing special needs education, serving on the boards of numerous bodies, and receiving several awards, culminating in her OBE in 1995 for services to education and the voluntary sector. The FSC, Juniper Hall and the Friends really have been very fortunate to have benefitted from her support, her friendship and her wise counsel all these years.

As her retirement present, Mavis asked for a wheelbarrow to replace her broken one. Although in her 90s, Mavis has two allotments. We wish her a long and happy retirement.

Sue Tatham

Good News – More Harebells in the Churchyard

In the July issue, I wrote about having to crawl on my hands and knees to identify some of the plant species in the closely mown areas of the churchyard. One of the most charming of these is the harebell. A few years ago, David Kennington found some in flower by gravestones on the north or rectory, side of the churchyard. Sadly, these were strimmed a few days later. This year, after having enjoyed some cake provided by the team organising the afternoon tea at the end of June, I had a look in this same area. There were the tiny round leaves of the harebell close to one of the old gravestones.

By July, these leaves had become scorched by the heat and dryness which has been a sad, climate breakdown feature of this summer and could not be re-found. Fortunately, on the south side of the churchyard and in the shade of a walnut tree, David and I found a few flowering stems of harebell by some old gravestones. These belonged to the Mortimer, Arnold and Bunce families. More excitingly, between these graves were good patches of the tiny round leaves that give harebell its scientific name of *Campanula rotundifolia*. In the recently updated Great Britain Red List for Plants, this species is in the Vulnerable category, based on its long-term losses and threat of extinction. What a treasure.

Incidentally, the accompanying image also shows a gravestone with abundant lichens on it. Mickleham churchyard is well known for its good number of lichen species. These grow on a range of substrates with the most important being the limestone headstones and some of the wooden surfaces.

Ann Sankey



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Round up of the First Three MCC Matches

The MCC vs Temple Sheen



MCC team for the match against Horley Strollers.

The skipper had the luxury of one of MCC's strongest bowling attacks in living memory. After the excellent opening spells from Michel and John Mark, Justin and Sunjo took over and formed a devastating first-change partnership. Temple Sheen soon found themselves 53-5, with Sunjo picking up two in two, and Justin grabbing a deserved wicket.

On a hot, sun-baked afternoon it was a fantastic display by all 11 players; the bowlers bowled accurately, the fielders threw themselves around, catches were caught (well nearly all of them) and we only conceded 6 extras, which must be a MCC record.

Tea was another triumph, huge thanks to Annie for getting all the food and drink prepared while the rest of us were in the field. Pete's savoury scones and homemade chilli jam were particular highlights.

Ali played a very intelligent and well-judged innings, supporting Sunjo, who the opposition inexplicably decided would be a good person to wind up. The phrase 'don't poke a sleeping bear' springs to mind as he proceeded to smash the bowling to all parts of the ground for a quick fire 30, and together with Ali, saw the MCC over the line with 5 overs to spare and 6 wickets in hand. In summary a fantastic maiden victory for the MCC over Temple Sheen.

Finally, a big shout out and thanks from me to Seb, Will and Giles. None of them had the chance to bat or bowl, but all three fielded despite carrying injuries, and all volunteered to umpire our innings. We don't have the luxury of a large squad and seem to be struggling on occasions to get XI players onto the field so people turning up, even when not fully fit, is hugely appreciated. It would be a real shame if we weren't able to fulfil the fixtures we've arranged.

Ollie Winters

The MCC vs Sutton

What a fantastic game. Thanks to Chris for organising us a new team to play at short notice. Sutton are a strong side, but we were not daunted. Kevin lost the toss and Sutton chose to bat. Justin and Kevin opened the bowling and stifled the free scoring Sutton. Justin ending on 7 overs 0 for 33 and Kevin 7 overs 2 for 30. Fielding was tight and energy was high. We continued to maintain pressure by taking wickets all through the innings. Gary Plahe bowled outstandingly finishing on 5 over 2 for 19. Our debutant Chris, John, Aaron and Peter all pitched in with a wicket apiece. Stunning catches from Will P and Kevin underscored a brilliant fielding display. Sutton did manage to score 219, however MCC were proud to keep them to this score with a never-say-die attitude.

Tea was spectacular. Peter B produced another delightful meal for our guests.

It was time to chase this huge score down. Seb opened the batting and smashed 4 beautiful cover drives. Seb's 18 set us up with a fast start. John held MCC together and produced and immense 9th wicket stand with Will P. Yes, that is right Will P. We believe this may be the highest 9th wicket partnership in the history of MCC, 64 runs. John ended on an amazing 76 and Will P 24.

We ended on a very respectable 170 against tough opposition. A great day out for all.

Kevin Walker

The MCC vs Horley Strollers

Kevin won the toss and opted to bat first. What followed was a batting masterclass. Inspired by Will P's heroics the previous week, Chris and Justin scored with aplomb. Chris with a professional 50 and Justin smashed 18 fours to get to 101. In true MCC spirit they both retired at the same time. What followed was a MCC batting collapse. Ollie playing with a broker rib, typifying the MCC courage, scored 17 and Gary 13. The rest were all single figures. We did end on a respectable 211.

Another tremendous tea was delivered (albeit with no actual tea, the urn has cooked dry) and a much-needed rest taken.

The Strollers have a formidable batting line up and we had to fight hard. Justin took a great catch down leg off Kevin's first ball. Justin went on to take 4 spectacular catches behind the wicket, 2 off one over from Gary P. Gary was on a hat trick but was to pull up lame in his third over. Gary P ended on 3 overs 2 for 17. Michel was the pick of the bowlers 1 wicket for 20 runs in 7 overs. Peter B also bowled well 1 wicket 5 overs for 27.

The Strollers batting in the end was too strong and MCC were beaten with 2 overs to go. It was a great game fought hard from start to finish. Next week we have the Sambuca Tigers, and we need a strong side for them.

Kevin Walker

Bonfire Build Dates

We need lots of new helpers please, to keep this tradition alive.

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JustGiving Fundraiser for Two Local Farmers

The appeal set up in July by residents concerned for local farmers, Nick Bullen and Mark Frost, has raised £6,000. This should help get them through the current dry spell. Both of them wanted to say a few words.

A very big thank you from Nick, sheep and cows. Thank you to everyone for their generosity at this difficult time. Some mornings going out to feed is extremely hard just looking at the dry desert that should be green grass.

Thank you to everyone who donated to help buy hay for my sheep and cows, when they would all rather be eating fresh grass. To add to the stress of feeding hay at this time of year, which I am having to buy in, the drought has meant also that I have made only half the hay I need for the winter.

We have tried to grow more resilient crops like lucerne and add deep rooting plants like chicory and plantain to the grass, but even they can only grow so much without rain! When it eventually rains it could take at least eight weeks for the grass to recover to produce enough grass growth to eat. It is stressed from heat and lack of rain.

So, this is the third drought in five years. The swallow holes have stopped the Mole flowing to Leatherhead in 1976, 2022 and now 2026. To have brown lawns and dirty cars is okay.

Nick Bullen

I would just like to say a huge thank you to the people of Mickleham and Westhumble for their tremendous generosity in the amount of money they have raised for Nick and me on the Just Giving page! This means so much to us and I have been overwhelmed by the response the appeal received.

Simon Collins of River Mole River Watch



The unusual sight of the river coming to a dead end with the exposed bed in the foreground.

This year has been hugely challenging in many ways, from the cost of everything that we need to buy for the farm inflating, to the milk price we are paid being unsustainable. Then to top it off the weather decided to not give us any rain for three months!

We are now in a drought, and the River Mole has stopped flowing through Norbury Park. There is no real rain in sight until somewhere in September, so this money will go a long way in supporting us to buy extra food that would otherwise have come out of our winter stocks. It means we can get ahead of the game and buy feed now at a more reasonable price, rather than being held to ransom in the winter. By then, all prices will be hiked because of the knock-on effect of everybody not having enough feed due to this everlasting dry spell and we would be desperate.

Thank you, thank you so much, the money will fill a big gap in the food supply of my farm. Not only that, to know the level of support we have in both villages has given us a huge morale boost which was very much needed because we haven't had a lot to shout about this year. When it feels like all the cards are stacked against us, something unexpected like this makes you realise that the situation will change. In the meantime, people are extremely supportive of both farms, which makes a huge difference.

Mark Frost

Andrew Tatham



The magazine rain correspondent, Ben Tatham (and daughter Jenny), helpfully points out the absence of water as the Mole disappears underground at the bottom of Young Street near to the Givons Grove roundabout. Ben has recorded that, in the nine weeks from 13th June to 14th August, there has been less than 1mm of rain in the area.



Outdoor Church Service to Celebrate Nature
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End of Term at the Nursery



At the end of July, we said a very fond farewell to our leavers. We are incredibly proud of them and all they have achieved during their time with us. We hope they take with them many happy memories and plenty of confidence and enthusiasm for whatever comes next.

Our older children also enjoyed a special outing towards the end of term. We wanted to give them an experience that was meaningful and perhaps something they might not normally do with their parents. Regular readers will be familiar with 'Snappy', our recycling crocodile box, which collects the children's crisp packets. We decided to show them where these packets go, so we arranged a trip to Waitrose in Dorking.

We caught the 465 bus and alighted at Dorking War Memorial, much to the surprise and delight of some customers as we donned our fluorescent tabards and entered the store! After a short lesson identifying and sorting materials, we deposited our recycling into the appropriate bins. We then headed to Meadowbank, where the children litter-picked in the park using our own child-sized litter pickers and several kindly borrowed from Dorking Library, a great activity for developing those fine motor skills. After a packed lunch in the new bandstand and a play in the park, we caught the bus back to nursery. We hope we are helping to create little citizens who care for and look after our environment.

In the final weeks, we also enjoyed our Sports Day. Past parents will be delighted to hear that one particularly important tradition remains firmly in place: the adults' hobby horse race. Competitive spirit was, as ever, alive and well with plenty of enthusiasm and laughter from the participants and spectators alike. We are pleased to report that no veterinary treatment was required this year!

Do you know about The Library of Things organised by Circular Dorking and stored at Dorking Library? This is where we borrowed the litter pickers from, but there is an eclectic inventory (including a cement mixer). It is well worth a look, especially if you have visiting grandchildren, or want to bake a car-shaped cake.

https://circulardorking.org.uk/projects/the-library-of-things/

Hilary Budd



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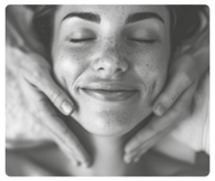
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From the Friends of St Michael's

September is normally the time we associate with 'going back to school' and all the excitement that brings for children and parents alike.

Sadly, as most know, our much loved St Michael's Infants School in Mickleham, will not be reopening its gates this month. As the Friends of St Michael's, our focus in the last few months before term broke up was on ensuring the children made the most of their precious time left and on giving them special memories to take with them to their new schools.

There were special workshops on drumming and rainforests. Some parents were brave enough to make the drumming more than a memory and elected to take a drum home! We had days out to the Natural History Museum and the new Paw Patrol World at Chessington (the accompanying staff may choose not to treasure this memory, but the kids had a blast!). We also supported the school in enabling families past and present and the wider community to celebrate the long life of the school and its continuing ability to bring people together, with a special event combining remembrance of the school's history and some fun and games for its most recent students.



Finally, at the very end of term each child received a tangible and cuddly symbol of their time at St Michael's, pictured below. These bears, with their badges proudly emblazoned on their chests, sum up what the children who have been lucky enough to attend the school will take away. This is a strong grounding in the positive values and skills that they will need for life but also having been loved and nurtured and given the confidence to fulfil their potential.

While we're undoubtedly sad that after such a long time the school has had to close its doors, we are grateful and happy for the time our children, and so many others over the years, have had there. We know they are well positioned for their new beginnings this September. Thank you to all the teachers, governors, Friends and other supporters who have made this possible.

Emma Machin
Treasurer of Friends of St Michael's

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Christmas Trees



Following the closure of St Michael's Infant School, the Mickleham Playground Association has taken over the sales of Christmas Trees to the community.

More details will follow in the October magazine.

Sarah Parfitt

Westhumble Bonfire, Saturday 7th November. See build dates on page 21. New builders very welcome.



Rivers of the World Word Search

Thank you to Barbara Jones for creating this month's word search. Names can go forwards backwards, horizontally, vertically or diagonally. Two word names appear without a gap between words.

E	E	O	W	W	R	E	Y	W	D	I	R	G	H	I
G	V	B	S	L	B	H	A	O	R	B	H	H	F	N
N	O	E	U	L	W	M	I	R	V	W	O	N	H	D
I	R	Z	E	N	A	J	A	N	P	C	N	T	H	U
L	U	T	E	Z	A	W	N	R	E	V	E	S	P	S
R	O	G	O	L	A	D	O	R	I	N	O	C	O	E
A	D	N	L	D	O	S	E	T	A	R	H	P	U	E
D	Q	A	D	Y	D	M	K	D	G	E	M	G	S	N
Y	J	Y	S	I	R	G	I	T	L	K	D	E	T	O
A	G	I	P	P	I	S	S	I	S	S	I	M	H	N
R	G	A	I	O	M	I	N	M	S	N	H	C	A	N
R	P	L	N	S	T	L	A	W	E	N	C	E	M	A
U	G	F	O	G	G	E	D	Y	L	C	C	Z	E	H
M	U	S	B	V	E	Z	A	M	B	E	S	I	S	S
W	R	E	X	I	S	S	O	R	M	T	H	C	A	H

Amazon
Clyde
Danube
Douro
Elbe
Euphrates
Ganges
Indus
Irrawaddy
Mississipi
Mole
Murray Darling
Nile
Orinoco
Rhine
Rhone
Seine
Severn
Shannon
Thames
Tigris
Volga
Yangtze
Zambesi

An Unusual Record of the Recent Eclipse

Never mind your pin-hole camera or colander against a piece of card, the partial solar eclipse on Wednesday 12th August was visible in the shadow cast by the leaves of a tree against a house wall. Captured by Alison Walton.



Solution to the July - August Cryptic Crossword

Across
1 Stud 4 Obliterate 9 Imbuing
10 Athwart 11 Stye 12 Democratic
16 Belgians 19 Lyrics 21 Estate
22 Need less 23 Brass tacks
28 Acme 29 Replays 30 Remains
31 Occidental 32 Host
Down
2 Temptress 3 Drupe 4 Owned
5 Idaho 6 Ether 7 Avast
8 Entices 13 Masonic 14 Calve
15 April 17 Gears 18 Agent
20 Casements 21 Embargo
24 Aspic 25 Sward 26 Arson
27 Spell 28 Abash

NB: There was also a 'Nina' – a hidden message

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2026-2027

Full Council Meetings
Start 7.30 pm
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Wednesday 9th September
Wednesday 11th November **at 8 pm**
Wednesday 27th January 2027
Wednesday 10th March 2027

Details of agendas/minutes will be available on the website.
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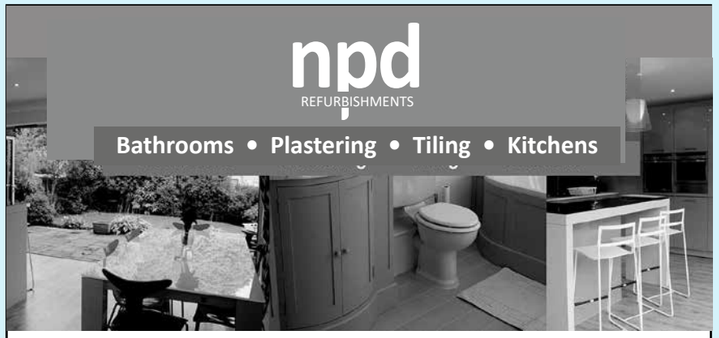
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